

Molly J. Doruska

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EDUCATION

Cornell University

Ph.D. in Applied Economics and Management
M.S. in Applied Economics and Management

Expected May 2026
2022

Lawrence University

B.A in Economics & French and Francophone Studies, *summa cum laude* 2019

PUBLICATIONS

Doruska, M. J., Barrett, C. B., and Rohr, J. R. (2024). Modeling how and why aquatic vegetation removal can free rural households from poverty-disease traps. *Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. U.S.A.* 121 (52), e2411838121, <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2411838121>.

Rohr, J. R., Sack, A., Bakhoun, S., Barrett, C. B., Lopez-Carr D., Chamberlin, A. J., Civitello, D. J., Diatta, C., **Doruska, M. J.**, De Leo, G., Haggerty, C. J. E., J Jones, I. J., Jouanard, N., Lund, A. J., Ly, A. T., Ndione, R. A., Remais, J. V., Riveau, G., Schacht, A., Seck, M., Senghor, S., Sokolow, S. H., and Wolfe, C. (2023). A planetary health innovation for disease, food, and water challenges in Africa. *Nature* 619, 782-787. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-023-06313-z>.

WORKING PAPERS

Molly J. Doruska. “Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal”

Molly J. Doruska, Christopher B. Barrett, Samba Mbaye, and Jason R. Rohr. “Estimating Demand When Turning a Public Bad into an Impure Public Good”

Kira Lanker, Laksmi Iyer, Faraz Usmani, James Allen IV, **Molly J. Doruska**, Samba Mbaye, Amina Sylla, Binta Sow, Jason R. Rohr, and Christopher B. Barrett. “Do private incentives crowd out public good donations? Evidence from a lab-in-the-field experiment” *Submitted*.

Musa Hasen Ahmed and **Molly J. Doruska**. “Paving the Way for Livestock Development: Rural Road Access and Agricultural Production in Ethiopia”

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Molly J. Doruska and Brian Dillon. “Changes in Surface Water Availability and Adaptation by Herders in Sub-Saharan Africa”

Christopher B. Barrett, Jason R. Rohr, Laksmi Iyer, Faraz Usmani, **Molly J. Doruska**, Nicolas Jouanard, Gilles Riveau, Samba Mbaye, Doudou Sow, Bruno Senghor, Tidjani Ly, Sidy

Bakhoun, James Allen IV, and Kira Lanker. “Integrating Socio-Economic and Environmental Interventions to Improve Well-Being in Vulnerable Communities”

Emily K. Selland, Nicolas Jouanard, Amadou Guisse, Momy Seck, Andrea J. Lund, David Lopez-Carr, Alexandra Sack, Louis Magblenou, Guilio A. De Leo, **Molly J. Doruska**, Christopher B. Barrett, Jason R. Rohr. “Rice-Fish Co-Culturing for Sustainability, Food Security, and Disease and Poverty Reduction”

OTHER WRITING

Rohr, J. R., Sack, A., Bakhoun, S., Barrett, C. B., Chamberlin, A. J., Civitello, D. J., **Doruska, M. J.**, De Leo, G. A., Forstchen, M., Haggerty, C. J. E., Jouanard, N., López-Carr, D., Lund, A. J., Ly, A. T., Seck, M., Selland, E., Sokolow, S. H., and Wolfe, C. (2025). A Planetary Health Adventure: How Removing Overgrown Water Plants Can Help Kids Stay Healthy and Improve the Planet. *Frontiers for Young Minds*.

Doruska, M. and Hoddinott, J. (2020) What works to reduce extreme poverty? A selective review. DEEP Working Paper 01. Data and Evidence to end Extreme Poverty Research Programme: Oxford. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.55158/DEEPWP1>

TEACHING

Trip Team Leader, Field visit to Senegal for AEM 4415: Social Enterprises in Emerging Markets, Student Multidisciplinary Applied Research Teams (SMART) Program at Cornell University Winter 2025

Graduate Teaching Assistant at Cornell University

AEM 2555: Corporate Sustainability: The Business Challenge	Spring 2020
AEM 4940/6940: Sustainable Business	Fall 2023
AEM 2000: Contemporary Controversies in the Global Economy	Spring 2024

Teaching Assistant at Lawrence University

ECON 380: Econometrics	Winter 2019
ECON 223: Quantitative Decision Making	Fall 2018

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Cornell University – Dyson School of Applied Economics & Management

Graduate Research Assistant for Christopher B. Barrett June 2020, June 2021 – Present

Graduate Research Assistant for John Hoddinott July 2020 – December 2020

Lawrence University

Research Assistant for Jonathan Lhost September 2018 – May 2019

GRANTS

PEDL Exploratory Research Grant, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal* [£31,678], 2024

STEG PhD Research Travel Grant, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal* [£14,161], 2024

Einaudi Center for International Studies Research Travel Grant [\$1,700], 2024

Cornell University Graduate School Research Travel Grant [\$1,550], 2024

J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative, *Adaptation to Long-Term Changes in Surface Water Availability by Herders in West Africa* [\$9,600], 2023

PRESENTATIONS

2025 Ecology and Evolution of Infectious Disease Conference, *Leveraging feedback loops: How integrating socio-economic and environmental interventions could reduce poverty*, June 2025

College of the Holy Cross, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal*, June 2025

AERE Summer Conference, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal*, May 2025

AERE Summer Conference, *Estimating Demand When Turning a Public Bad into an Impure Public Good*, May 2024

Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), *Estimating Demand When Turning a Public Bad into an Impure Public Good*, March 2024

AAEA Annual Meeting, *Modeling how and why aquatic vegetation removal can free rural households from poverty-disease traps*, July 2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

George F. Warren Award, First Place, Cornell University for Doruska et al.	2025
International Champion, Frontiers Planet Prize for Rohr et al.	2024
Sustainability Science Award, The Ecological Society of America for Rohr et al.	2024
United States National Champion, Frontiers Planet Prize for Rohr et al.	2024
William A. McConagha Prize, Lawrence University (Senior student who best exhibits excellence in the study of economics)	2019
Iden Charles Champion Award in Commerce & Industry, Lawrence University (Best economics paper)	2019

Philip and Rosemary Wiley Bradley Achievement Scholarship in Economics, Lawrence University 2018
(Scholarship awarded to junior student to encourage talented and industrious students to major in the field of economics)

SERVICE

Referee Service, *Food Policy*
Reviewer, *AERE Summer Conference 2025, STARS/STAARS program*
Peer Mentor, STARS/STAARS program, 2022 – 2023, 2024 – 2025
President, Applied Economics and Management Graduate Student Association, 2021 – 2022
Founder and Co-Chair, Dyson Diversity Council, 2021 – Present
President, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2024 – 2025
Chair, Graduate Students for Gender Equity in Economics, 2023 – 2024
Vice President, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2022 – 2023
Member, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2021 – Present
Co-Founder, Development Tea, 2023

MISCELLANEOUS

Languages: English (native); French (advanced), Wolof (beginning)
Software: Stata, R, Julia, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, SurveyCTO, LaTeX, Microsoft Office Suite
Athletic: Marathoner; Women's Open age group captain, Finger Lakes Running Club cross country team; Competed in varsity cross country, indoor, and outdoor track for Lawrence University, 2015-2019; MVP of Women's Track & Field 2019; Breakthrough female athlete of the year, Lawrence University Athletics Department, 2019